

Incident Case Report Template

1. Case Information

- **Case ID:** 004
- **Case Title:** updater.exe
- **Date / Time of Detection:** Sep. 11, 2025 16:52:04 (2025-09-11 14:52:04 UTC)
- **Reported by:** CrowdStrike Falcon (EDR Alert)
- **Case Owner:** Ali YILMAZ

2. Incident Summary

- **Description of the Incident:**
Because the related Prevention Policy setting was off, the process was not blocked
- **Initial Alert Source:**
CrowdStrike Falcon (EDR Alert)
- **Classification:**
T1204.002 – User Execution: Malicious File
- **Severity Level:** High

3. Investigation Details

3.1 Indicators of Compromise (IoCs)

- **IP Addresses:** None
- **Domains / URLs:** None
- **File Hashes:**
870eda04ea71cc066ec907f005e1d05ce592f04799c60e600e2cb986dc85b5eb

3.2 OSINT & Threat Intelligence Findings

- **VirusTotal:** Matches rule System File Execution Location Anomaly by Florian Roth (Nextron Systems), Patrick Bareiss, Anton Kutepov, oscd.community, Nasreddine Bencherchali at Sigma Integrated Rule Set (GitHub)
- *Detects a Windows program executable started from a suspicious folder*

4. MITRE ATT&CK Mapping

Tactic (Category)	Technique (ID & Name)	Evidence in Case
Initial Access	T1204.002 User Execution: Malicious File	[Yes]
Execution	T1204 (User Execution) → <i>PowerShell executed by user interaction</i>	[Yes]
Persistence	T1547 – Boot or Logon Autostart Execution	[No]
Privilege Escalation	N/A	N/A
Defense Evasion	N/A	N/A
Credential Access	T1110 – Brute Force	[No]
Discovery	N/A	N/A
Lateral Movement	N/A	N/A
Collection	N/A	N/A
Exfiltration	N/A	N/A
Command and Control (C2)	T1071 – Application Layer Protocol	[No]

(Fill only relevant ones, mark N/A if not applicable)

5. Timeline of Events

Time (UTC)	Event Description	Source (Log/Alert)	Notes
Sep. 11, 2025 16:52:04 (2025-09-11 14:52:04 UTC)	Detection of alert	CrowdStrike Falcon (EDR Alert)	...
[2025-09-15]	Analyst OSINT check started	VirusTotal / Filescan.io	...

Time (UTC)	Event Description	Source (Log/Alert)	Notes
[(2025-09-15]	Escalation / Ticket created	#6306 TheHive	...

6. Result & Assessment

- **Final Verdict:** [True Positive – Malicious Execution]
- **Impact Assessment:**
 - Affected Users/Hosts: [DESKTOP-44AO68N]
 - Business Impact: [High] If not detected and contained, the masqueraded executable could have enabled an attacker to perform system reconnaissance and identify local users, groups, and installed patches. This would increase the risk of privilege escalation and lateral movement within the corporate environment. Such activity could have led to unauthorized access to sensitive data and potential business disruption. In this case, CrowdStrike Falcon successfully quarantined the malicious file, preventing further impact.
 - **7. Recommended Actions**
- **Technical Actions (SOC):**
 - Block and blacklist the malicious file hash (daec8e2c2ce149139bfdd19cde126d70ef95eee25e3087f0ee563f50d65c993e).
 - Quarantine the affected host (HR-01-MIKE) and verify no persistence mechanisms were established.
 - Review SIEM/EDR logs for additional executions of the same file or similar masqueraded binaries.
 - Monitor for abnormal PowerShell activity (e.g., Get-LocalUser, Get-LocalGroup, Get-Hotfix commands).
 - Search for potential lateral movement attempts or account manipulation (net user, net localgroup administrators).
 - Update detection rules (YARA/Sigma) to alert on renamed/masqueraded binaries.
- **Organizational / HR Actions:**
 - ☒ Conduct targeted security awareness training for the involved user on safe downloading and execution practices.
 - Reinforce phishing and malicious file awareness across the organization (internal newsletter / awareness session).
 - Remind staff to verify software sources and avoid running executables from unknown or untrusted locations.
 - No HR disciplinary actions required at this stage.

8. Case Closure

- **Closure Date:** Sep. 15, 2025 21:00
- **Closed by:** Ali YILMAZ
- **Case Status:** Closed

Screenshots:

The screenshot displays the Microsoft Defender Endpoint Security interface. The top navigation bar includes 'Endpoint security', 'Endpoint detections', and a search bar. The main content area is titled 'Details' and shows information for 'updater.exe on HR-01-MIKE by Mike'.

Tags: true_positive

Description: This file meets the machine learning-based on-sensor AV protection's high confidence threshold for malicious files.

Summary:

- Severity: High
- Process: updater.exe
- Tactic & technique: Machine Learning via Sensor-based ML
- Start time: Sep. 11, 2025 16:51:48
- End time: Sep. 11, 2025 17:03:19
- Assigned to: Murat Saglam
- Status: In progress

Full details:

Process - See more details

Process: updater.exe

Actions taken: None

Objective: Filecoin Detection Method

Tactic: Machine Learning

Technique: Sensor-based ML

Technique ID: CST0007

IOA name: ML Sensor-I-figh

Command line: "C:\Users\Mike\Downloads\updater.exe"

File path: \Device\HarddiskVolume3\Users\Mike\Downloads\updater.exe

Hash:

755b647f859243e79c5ad06fbf261d2b2c8ce63768121e2e82454e59bed79d59

Activity:

External prevalence	Internal prevalence	Last seen	# of hosts	# of detections	Hash action
Low	Unique	Sep. 11, 2025 16:59:11	1	0	No action

Host:

HR-01-MIKE

Host:

OS	IP address	Local IP address
Windows 10	37.154.108.72	10.0.2.15

User:

Mike

Process actions:

Network operations:

- Network Connect (IPv4): 1
- Network Close (IPv4): 1
- Disk operations: 73
- No DNS requests
- No registry operations
- No process operations

Endpoint detections | Endpoint

Search detections Q Severity Time Status Tactic Technique Tags User name: Mike Host Add/remove filters + Clear all

List is up to date Aggregate detections Off Group by Sort by Time: Newest to oldest

Because the related Prevention Policy setting was off, the process was not blocked

Severity High Detect time 16:52:04 Process on host updater.exe on HR-01-MIKE Tactic via tech... Machine L... Triggering file updater.exe Hostname HR-01-MIKE User n Mike

HR-01-MIKE

winlogon.exe 0 0 0 0 0 0 13 0

userinit.exe 0 0 0 0 0 0 2 0

explorer.exe 0 0 0 0 0 0 91 3

updater.exe 0 0 0 0 0 0 73 2

55 results (1-50 shown) Items per page 50 Page 1 of 2 See full detection

Sep. 11, 2025 16:52:04

updater.exe on HR-01-MIKE by Mike Investigate Actions

Edit status Network contain Cannot connect to host

No notes from Overwatch

No related adversaries

Status

Process

Filescan.io Community

REPORTS TRENDS HUNTING LEADERBOARD API FEED BLOG Start Tour EN SIGN IN

conhost.exe / Overview Download File Download Report

conhost.exe LIKELY MALICIOUS # SHA 256 b02ee54fb2ec69673386d4119ee8e083... [penze] [adaptive-context] [anti-debug] +4

Overview File Details Threat Indicators Indicators of Compromise Similarity Search Disassembly Sections YARA Rules Extracted Strings Extracted Files OSINT Lookups

Threat Indicators View Threat Indicators (25)

Likely Malicious 1 Suspicious 10 No Threat 14

TOP THREAT INDICATORS

Found a suspicious native API string artifact

May dynamically load APIs used to manipulate/query other processes [Discovery (2)]

May dynamically load APIs used for anti-debugging purposes

Found a living off the land (LotL) or Windows desktop utility string artifact [Execution (1)] [Defense Evasion (1)]

PE imports APIs used to access or modify privilege levels [Discovery (1)] [Defense Evasion (1)]

Indicators Of Compromise View IOCs (76)

TOP INDICATORS OF COMPROMISE

IP 5.1.0.0

MD5 024136a91811ab0c5825f5dc6648abf6

MD5 0df334b916c1632c3a9e39dcecc3a3b5a

MD5 11392b8d033615890a8a1c2770c80b64

MD5 2491b4b680f92eda568c3e406270d9b6

MD5 2ac784a32bb176b22b090da9302ef1d4

MD5 2b0579cb5b0956aa92b0f608b96cd443

Emulation Data Learn More

Processes Network Other

Emulation Data is not applicable for this file. Learn more

File Details View File Details

1 input 24 Extracted Files

Report ID: fb956173-0126-47bf-9b8d-b32c4d93e536

Media type: application/x-msdownload; format=pe64

Size: 847.50 kB

Submission: 2 months ago

File magic: PE32+ executable (GUI) x86-64, for MS Windows

Entropy: 6.4

Strings: 1,623

AD

OPSWAT MetaDefender Sandbox Discover the complete suite of Filescan.io - Next-Gen Malware Analysis Platform's robust commercial solutions! Explore the full range of features and offerings by clicking here.

SCAN STAGES

SANDBOX Deep Static Analysis

823 Obfuscation techniques checked

76 Indicators of Compromise

1/24 Threat Indicators

OPSWAT Reputation Service

23 Reputation and cross-checks

6 Indicators of Compromise

1 Threat Indicators

Endpoint detections | Endpoint secu... Sep. 11, 2025 16:52:04 | Endpoint de... Sep. 11, 2025 16:52:04 | Endpoint de... Event search | Next-Gen SIEM | Falcon | VirusTotal - File - 870eda04ea71c066ec907f005e1d05ce592f04799c60e600e2cb986dc85b5eb

870eda04ea71c066ec907f005e1d05ce592f04799c60e600e2cb986dc85b5eb

Community Score: -15

PowerShell.EXE

Size: 425.50 KB | Last Analysis Date: 2 days ago

peexe known-distributor lang: sleep detect: debug-environment

DETECTION DETAILS RELATIONS BEHAVIOR COMMUNITY 17

Crowdsourced Sigma Rules

CRITICAL 0 HIGH 1 MEDIUM 2 LOW 1

Matches rule **System File Execution Location Anomaly** by Florian Roth (Nextron Systems), Patrick Bareiss, Anton Kutevov, oscd.community, Nasreddine Bencherchali at Sigma Integrated Rule Set (GitHub)

Detects a Windows program executable started from a suspicious folder

Matches rule **PowerShell Core DLL Loaded By Non PowerShell Process** by Tom Kern, oscd.community, Natalia Shomikova, Tim Shelton, Roberto Rodriguez (Cybr3rWard0z), OTR (Open Threat Research) at Sigma Integrated Rule Set (GitHub)

Detects loading of essential DLLs used by PowerShell, but not by the process powershell.exe. Detects behaviour similar to meterpreter's "load powershell" extension.

Matches rule **PSScriptPolicyTest Creation By Uncommon Process** by Nasreddine Bencherchali (Nextron Systems) at Sigma Integrated Rule Set (GitHub)

Detects the creation of the "PSScriptPolicyTest" PowerShell script by an uncommon process. This file is usually generated by Microsoft PowerShell to test against AppLocker.

Matches rule **Renamed Powershell Under Powershell Channel** by Harish Segar, track113 at Sigma Integrated Rule Set (GitHub)

Detects renamed powershell

Security vendors' analysis

Do you want to automate checks?

Acronis (Static ML) Undetected AhnLab-V3 Undetected

Endpoint detections | Endpoint secu... Sep. 11, 2025 16:52:04 | Endpoint de... Sep. 11, 2025 16:52:04 | Endpoint de... Event search | Next-Gen SIEM | Falcon | VirusTotal - File - 870eda04ea71c066ec907f005e1d05ce592f04799c60e600e2cb986dc85b5eb

falcon.eu-1.crowdstrike.com/activity-v2/detections/74a413757ad45e9a7182da65337c8a8ind0bf0ee90b584a038705a1003a18667e21909742344...

Endpoint security | Endpoint detections | Sep. 11, 2025 16:52:04

Details Process table Process tree Process graph Events timeline

Is Hacker here?

powershell.exe

Process

HR-01-MIKE

User name: HR-01-MIKE\Mike Local process ID: 7320

Command line: powershell -c "Write-Output '7ereh rekcah si'"

File path: \Device\HarddiskVolume3\Windows\SysWOW64\WindowsPowerShell\v1.0\powershell.exe

Executable SHA256: 870eda04ea71c066ec907f005e1d05ce592f04799c60e600e2cb986dc85b5eb

Start time: Sep. 11, 2025 17:00:00 End time: Sep. 11, 2025 17:00:12 Duration: 12s

CyberSecurity/CrowdStrike/Usecase/... 4-Case - T1204.002 User Execution M User Execution: Malicious File, SI... x

attackmitre.org/techniques/T1204/002/

English Turkish x

MITRE | ATT&CK

Matrices Tactics Techniques Defenses CTI Resources Benefactors Blog Search

ATT&CKcon 6.0 is coming October 14-15 in McLean, VA and live online. Tickets are available now!

TECHNIQUES

Malicious File

Malicious Image

Malicious Copy and Paste

Windows Management Instrumentation

Persistence

Privilege Escalation

Defense Evasion

Credential Access

Discovery

Lateral Movement

Collection

Command and Control

Exfiltration

Impact

Home > Techniques > Enterprise > User Execution > Malicious File

User Execution: Malicious File

Other sub-techniques of User Execution (4)

An adversary may rely upon a user opening a malicious file in order to gain execution. Users may be subjected to social engineering to get them to open a file that will lead to code execution. This user action will typically be observed as follow-on behavior from Spearphishing Attachment. Adversaries may use several types of files that require a user to execute them, including .doc, .pdf, .xls, .rtf, .scr, .exe, .lnk, .pif, .cpl, and .reg.

Adversaries may employ various forms of Masquerading and Obfuscated Files or Information to increase the likelihood that a user will open and successfully execute a malicious file. These methods may include using a familiar naming convention and/or password protecting the file and supplying instructions to a user on how to open it.^[1]

While Malicious File frequently occurs shortly after Initial Access it may occur at other phases of an intrusion, such as when an adversary places a file in a shared directory or on a user's desktop hoping that a user will click on it. This activity may also be seen shortly after Internal Spearphishing.

ID: T1204.002

Sub-technique of: T1204

Tactic: Execution

Platforms: Linux, Windows, macOS

Contributors: TruKno

Version: 1.5

Created: 11 March 2020

Last Modified: 15 April 2025

Version Permalink